

Individual Training

The Army Approach: an emerging synthesis



COMMANDER'S QUESTION

What is the Army approach to individual training?

EMERGING PROPOSITION

Army develops individuals progressively and continuously toward operational competence, balancing direction, practice, experience and learner agency according to risk, complexity, competence and operational need.

The standard is common; the journey to it need not be identical.

The Emerging Model



HOW FAR AND HOW FAST AN INDIVIDUAL PROGRESSES IS DETERMINED BY

Risk × Complexity × Learner Competence × Required Operational Outcome

Individual training continues across a career through a recurring cycle:



Emerging Takeaways

The evidence underpinning the approach above.

1
Individual training exists to produce operational competence.
Course completion is a means, not the end. Success is whether an individual can perform to the required standard, in role and under operational conditions.

4
The level of direction should change as competence grows.
Foundational and high-risk training requires greater standardisation and instructor control. As competence develops, learner autonomy, complexity, experiential learning and reflection can increase.

2
The standard is common; the learning journey need not be identical.
Individuals arrive with different experience, competence and learning needs. Army adapts the pathway without diluting the standard, and retains operational assurance in doing so.

5
Individual training extends beyond the course.
Formal instruction, digital and distributed learning, simulation, coaching, workplace experience, feedback and reinforcement are complementary parts of one continuous system. Learning should be accessible before, during and after formal training.

3
Competence develops progressively through practice, experience and feedback.
Training should move deliberately from foundation knowledge and guided practice toward independent application, judgement and performance under pressure.

6
The method is selected to achieve the outcome.
Instructors, technology, learning frameworks, simulation, data and AI are enablers, not the Army approach itself. Their value depends on people being competent and practised in their use, and on improving practice, feedback, adaptation and evidence of performance.